CAT 2025

MBA FASTRACK

Lecture- 07 | **Verbal Ability**

Para-jumbles 1

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TOPICS *to be covered*

1. Approach to Para-jumbles
2. Composition of a paragraph
3. Practice with MCQs

Question 1

Choose the option that best captures the meaning of the following idiom:

To get under somebody's skin

A. To deceive someone
B. To admire someone
C. To annoy someone
D. To support someone

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Question 2

Select the alternative expressing the most appropriate meaning of the underlined Idiom.

While I have a bath, you may <u>chew the cud</u>.

A. Kill time
B. Go through legalities
C. Reflect upon one's past
D. Have breakfast

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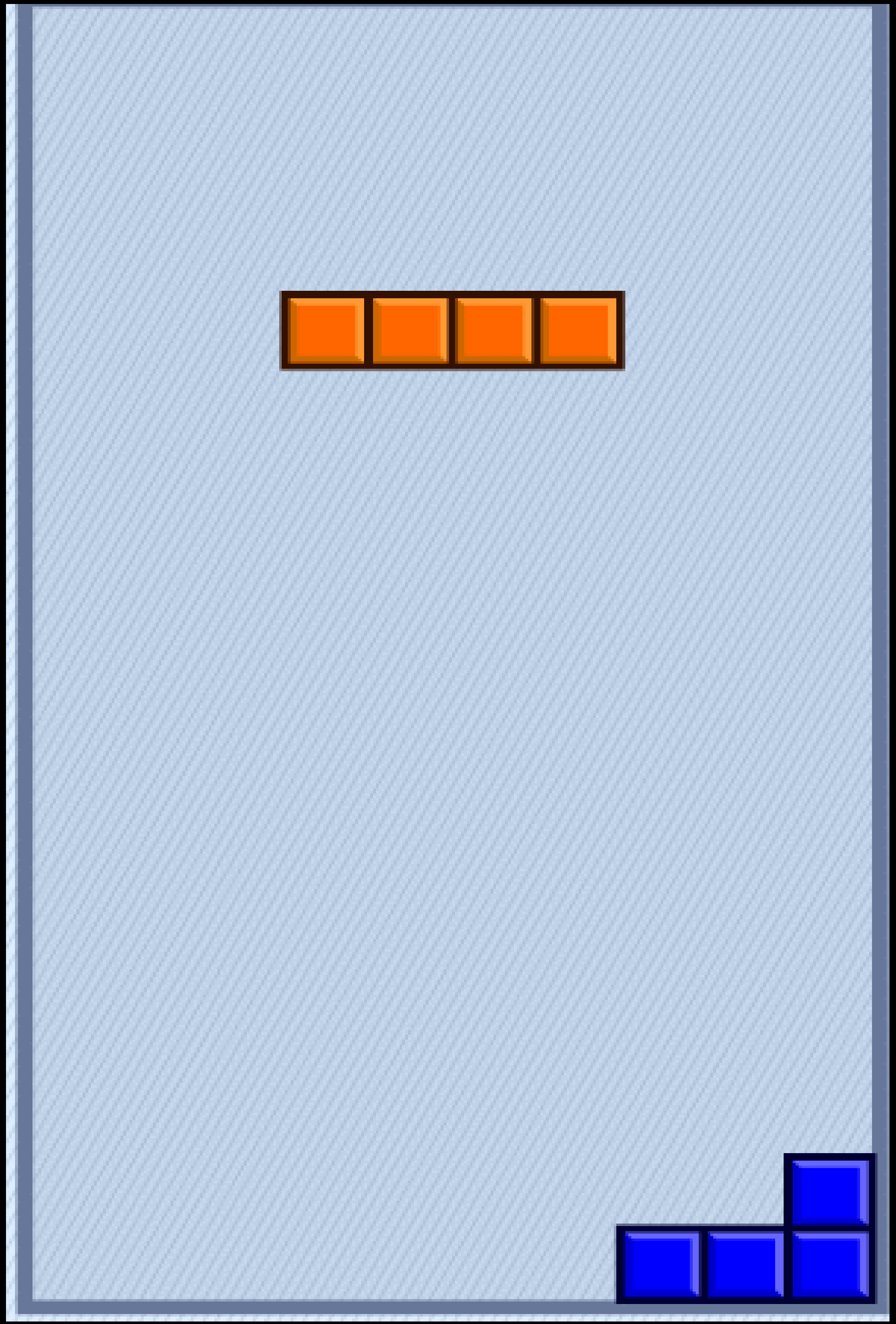
Topic: Para-jumbles 1

Para-jumbles 1

The Basics

Foundation



What are Para-jumbles?

Para-jumbles = a Jumbled Paragraph

“
A paragraph whose sentences are jumbled. The examiner wants us to figure out the correct order/sequence of the sentences.
”

Running

$\simeq 8,000$

$\simeq 500$ 2.5 Lakh

Why does the examiner have para-jumbles in the paper?

Why Para-jumbles?

- The primary purpose is to test you writing / composition skills

Essay → 2.5 Lakh

- The secondary purpose is to test how you perform when it comes to application of everything all the other component of English

What is a Paragraph?

What is a paragraph?

- A paragraph is a distinct piece of writing which often has more than one sentence and is separated from other paragraphs by a space.
- All the sentences of a paragraph relate to the same topic.
- All the sentences of a well-written paragraph are coherent. = flow

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Why do we use paragraphs?

"A paragraph helps a reader organize the text in his mind."

Corruption in India

- **Para 1** - Introduction
- **Para 2** - Effects of Corruption in India
- **Para 3** - Causes of Corruption in India
- **Para 4** - Solution for Corruption in India
- **Para 5** - Conclusion

Components of a paragraph

Topic Sentence = Topic + Aspect
Supporting sentence 1 Supporting sentence 2 Support sentence 3… + Examples, Facts, Stats…
Concluding sentence ≠ Conclusion

Approach to Para-jumbles

32 41

why?

The Approach

- Intuitive ✗
  - Need to be Well-read
  - Falters under pressure
  - Inconsistent Results
- Scientific ✓

Scientific Approach to Para-jumbles

look for clues

- Read all the sentences actively
- Avoid the temptation of looking for the opening sentence

Is it an opening sentence?

1. India's brilliant minds, however, have not received the acclaim or support they deserve, especially after their historic double gold at the Chess Olympiad back in September, from the government or corporate houses.
2. Nations that have reached there, including South Korea, are struggling to revive population growth.
3. As of now, both sides stay focused on phase one.

Scientific Approach to Para-jumbles

$3 \rightarrow 1$

$3+1$

- Read all the sentences actively
- Avoid the temptation of looking for the opening sentence
- Identify sequences and mandatory pairs using word-based and idea-based clues.

Word-based Clues

- 'The' = Definite Article
- Noun – Pronoun Relationship

Example 1

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3124

1 → 2

1. Its new publication on this subject is an attempt to lend teachers a helping hand.
2. It unfolds in two sections: Climate change: how to make sense of it all and natural resources: how to share & care.
3. Environment Education unit of Centre for Science & Environment has always been working towards providing easy to understand reading material.
4. However, they are introduced to students not as a paragraph to memorize but as an activity to do.

Plural pronoun

Word-based Clues

- ‘The’
- Noun – Pronoun Relationship
- Transitional Expressions

Paragraph

I don’t wish to deny that the flattened, minuscule head of the large-bodied "stegosaurus" houses little brain from our subjective, top-heavy perspective, but I do wish to assert that we should not expect more of the beast. First of all, large animals have relatively smaller brains than related, small animals. The correlation of brain size with body size among kindred animals (all reptiles, all mammals, for example) is remarkably regular. As we move from small to large animals, from mice to elephants or small lizards to Komodo dragons, brain size increases, but not so fast as body size. In other words, bodies grow faster than brains, and large animals have low ratios of brain weight to body weight. In fact, brains grow only about two-thirds as fast as bodies. Since we have no reason to believe that large animals are consistently stupider than their smaller relatives, we must conclude that large animals require relatively less brain to do as well as smaller animals. If we do not recognize this relationship, we are likely to underestimate the mental power of very large animals, dinosaurs in particular.

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Transitional Expressions

- To sequence ideas

  first, second, next, then, after this, finally, accordingly, meanwhile, henceforth, lastly

- To introduce an additional Idea

  also, furthermore, additionally, in addition, moreover, similarly, likewise, as well as, besides, another, too

Transitional Expressions

- To introduce an opposite idea

  in contrast, conversely, alternatively, yet, although, even though, nevertheless, notwithstanding, however, on the other hand, whereas, while, instead, otherwise

- To introduce an example

  for example, such as, for instance, to demonstrate, namely, in particular, e.g.

Transitional Expressions

- To indicate a conclusion / consequence

  consequently, accordingly, as a result, hence, subsequently, therefore, thus, thereupon, as a consequence, for this reason, wherefore, that is why

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Example 2

2413

1. Thus, despite India's huge population, we have not done well in Olympic Games.
2. Cricket has been an extremely popular game in India for quite some time now.
3. It is time our government and corporate fraternity ~~pay~~ paid due attention to other sports, and we redeem our national pride in Olympic Games.
4. However, due to this reason, other games/sports did not receive the required attention they deserve.

Indian Institute of Mgmt. ; IIM

Word-based Clues

- 'The'
- Noun – Pronoun Relationship
- Transitional Expressions
- Chronological Sequence = Timeline
  - Dates / months / years
  - Before, After, After that, Later, Then
- Abbreviations and Acronyms
- Full Name and Part of the Name

Idea-based Clues

Symptom → Diagnosis → Problem → Solution

Idea-based Clues

- Teaching → Exams
- Exams → Results
- Factory → Production
- Profit → Bonus
- Vikrant → Success in English

Scientific Approach to Para-jumbles

- Read all the sentences actively
- Avoid the temptation of looking for the opening sentence
- Identify sequences and mandatory pairs using <u>word-based</u> and <u>idea-based</u> clues.
- Use the elimination approach* to arrive at the answer. = Only for MCQs

C+A

Question 1

D+B

A. However, the real challenge today is in unlearning, which is much harder. (than what?)

B. But the new world of business behaves differently from the world in which we grew up.

C. Learning is important for both people and organisations.

D. Each of us has a 'mental model' that we've used over the years to make sense.

A. CADB

B. BDAC

C. CDAB

D. ACBD

Question 2

A. The oldest fossil grasses are just 70 million years old, although grass may have evolved a bit earlier than that.

B. There have been land plants for 465 million years, yet there were no flowers for over two-thirds of that time.

C. The equally-familiar grasses appeared even more recently.

D. Flowering plants only appeared in the middle of the dinosaur era.

B+D → C

A. DCBA

B. BCAD

C. CADB

D. BDCA

Question 3

C → A

D → B

C → D

A. General Yi knew that the Ming dynasty was more powerful than Mongols were and judged that if he attacked, the Ming would likely invade Korea.

B. Upon his arrival in Kaesŏng, General Yi toppled the government through a military coup and in 1392 CE, he placed himself on the throne — ushering in the Chosŏn Kingdom.

C. Due to his prominence in 1388 CE, the anti-Ming (pro-Mongol) faction sent General Yi to expel a contingent of Ming troops stationed on the northern part of the Korean Peninsula.

D. Seeing the campaign as a potential disaster, General Yi turned his troops south towards the Koryŏ capital, Kaesŏng.

X A. ACDB

✓ B. CADB ✓

X C. ADCB

X D. CBDA ✓

Question 4

C → B

A → D

B → A

A. Elite American colleges are now widely suspected of admitting male applicants with lower grades, to even up the numbers.

B. At least in the rich world, $\boxed{\text{that wasteful truth}}$ has been triumphantly overcome.

C. Stendhal once wrote that all geniuses who were born women were lost to the public good.

D. Yet, despite $\boxed{\text{this monumental advance,}}$ much ability, both male and female, is wasted because of tenacious stereotypes.

A. ~~ABDC~~

B. ~~ADCB~~

C. CBAD

D. ~~CDBA~~

Question 5

E + B

A. The State's significant human resources contribution to the ever-expanding IT sector is also attributed to the English fluency of its recruits as much as to their technical knowledge.

B. However, its voluntary learning has never been restricted and the growth over the past decade in the number of CBSE schools, where the language is taught, would bear testimony to this.

C. The two-language policy of Tamil and English has thus far worked well in the State.

D. In a liberalised world, more windows to the world are being opened up for those proficient in English, a global link language.

E. There is this counter-argument that Tamil Nadu is depriving students of an opportunity to learn Hindi, touted as a national link language.

A. ACEBD

~~B.~~ BECAD

~~C.~~ EACDB

D. CDAEB

Question 6

A. There will be an inaugural session with director’s address in the morning.

B. As Phase-II is based on discussions and sharing their DPT experience, the online classes will help the probationers in finishing the training within a given time frame.

C. Moreover, the academy is also conducting a series of online tests and assessment was done in real time.

D. In a first, the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy will conduct online classes for the IPS probationers who are stranded in their allotted cadres after completion of District Practical Training (DPT) due to COVID-19 lockdown.

E. Starting from Tuesday, the 137 probationers have to remote login and attend three online classes for at least four hours a day as part of the Phase II of their training.

A. BADEC

B. EDBAC

C. DAEBC

D. CABED

SUMMARY

- Approach to para-jumbles
- Components of a paragraph
- MCQs

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"Becoming fearless isn't the point. That's impossible. It's learning how to control your fear, and how to be free from it."

—Divergent by Veronica Roth


THANK
You